

Ohio River Trail Council



1100 Pennsylvania Av
Monaca, Pa 15061
724-728-2625

MINUTES

DATE 06-25-2013

TIME 3:00 PM

MONACA MUNICIPAL BUILDING

MEETING CALLED BY	Dr. Vincent Troia
TYPE OF MEETING	Board Meeting
FACILITATOR	Dr. Vincent Troia
NOTE TAKER	Donna Campbell, Secretary

Attendees: Dr. Vincent Troia, John Szatkiewicz, Linda Tice, Donna Campbell, Melinda McKee, Raymond Tabay, Nicholas L Giles, Paul Rogers, Bill Sweterlisch

Agenda topics: Gear & Beer Fall Fest, Water Trail, Donations, Grants, Beaver River Trail-ORTC Merger

DISCUSSION	Meeting called to order by Dr. Vincent Troia with the introduction of Paul Rogers of CCBC, Nick Giles and Raymond Tabay from the Beaver County Rowing Association
DISCUSSION	Dr. Vincent Troia informed the group that the ORTC was incorporated in 2009, so we are now four years into the trail project. We have approximately \$600,000 in grants and we will be looking forward to breaking down the South Shore Trail Phases encompassing Coraopolis/ Moon Township, Hopewell, Monaca/Center Township, and Moon Township/Crescent. The project will not necessarily commence in that order but rather based on which communities are more interested. Dr. Troia also reminded us to keep the North Shore Phases in mind. We already have a \$15,000 grant from First Energy for the North Shore Feasibility Study, which included Beaver Falls, New Brighton, Rochester Township, Beaver, Bridgewater, Vanport, Midland, Ohioville and Industry. An additional North Shore Extension would include Sewickley, Edgeworth, Leetsdale, Ambridge and South Heights. A detailed list of donations and approved grants was then reviewed by the group. Also the DCNR \$200,000 grant for Phase I, pending and the \$600,000 EPA Brownfield Remediation Grant which Mario Leone has reported that we did not receive. Another grant coming available for application is the Allegheny Regional Asset District \$200,000 grant. The Allegheny Land Trust has agreed to manage this grant and submit application for us for a fee of \$500.00. Dr. Vincent Troia doesn't know if their submission is more to our advantage or not.
DISCUSSION	The Beaver Falls Rails to Trails Association is interested in merging with the ORTC. Dr. Vincent Troia, Paul Rogers, Ernie Piscioti and Todd Stevenson are working with Attorney Vincent Tucceri on the Articles of Merger. This would enable us to obtain only one liability policy for both groups and helps with access to the water trail as well. John Szatkiewicz stated that the Wallace Run River access has also been placed back on the list for development by the Fish and Boat Commission
	Dr. Vincent Troia stated that the Municipalities must proceed with the development of Intergovernmental agreements. Monaca and Midland have executed their agreements. The remaining municipalities must get started on theirs as Moon Township cannot get the DCNR grant without the intergovernmental agreement. There must be a detail of who will maintain the trail and to what points. Duquesne Light has also given verbal permission to the ORTC to use their utility line but the "license" is forthcoming.

	Dr. Troia reviewed the trail easement projects that connects with Rochester Flag park, which has appealing scenery along the trail. The key property along the North Shore is the Norfolk Southern/National Fuel site, which connects with the new Veterans Bridge running along the bank of the Beaver river. It is very serene and nice along this section of the proposed riverside trail.
DISCUSSION	An RFP has been submitted to PennDOT for Coraopolis for TCSP Program Grant. The ORTC Trail Town Tracker has been developed to track the individual communities' in an effort to see what they have accomplished.
DISCUSSION	The Beaver River Trail Golf Outing Brochure was reviewed by the group and following the merger have a Golf Outing as a fundraising effort.
DISCUSSION	A review of the Insurance premiums was presented with Liability premium totaling \$1800.00, D & O premium of \$700.00 and Event premium of \$900.00. The Event premium could be discounted by \$100.00 to \$200.00 if the Beer Vendors at the Festival provide a certificate of insurance.
DISCUSSION	Dr. Vincent Troia announces that the Upper Ohio River PA section has been approved as a designated PA water trail as of January 4, 2013. Dr. Troia will now work to get the trail listed on the PA Fish and Boat Commission website. Dr. Troia stated he would like to put the map and guide in an outdoor message center locked and waterproofed at each launch site along the trail. Dr. Vincent Troia also met with executives of Huntington National Bank and presented some possibilities for sponsorship of the message centers including listing them at the site as the sponsor. They are excited to help with the project. John Szatkiewicz mentioned that the Boy Scouts also look for sign projects for their Badge and Eagle Scout Program.
DISCUSSION	Dr. Troia suggested a grand opening of the water trail but need volunteers to chair the event. Linda Tice and John Szatkiewicz will do this. Dr. Troia also wrote to the Commissioners requesting a donation to print 20,000 water trail maps for \$3900.00, in lieu of the 10,000 for \$2,650.00. Melinda McKee and Donna Campbell agreed to chair the booth at the Beaver County River Regatta to be held August 16 th to 18th. The Kayak Race is on Saturday, August 17 th , however everyone agreed that it might be better to tie the Water Trail Grand Opening to the "Anything that Floats" event on Sunday, August 18th.
DISCUSSION	A Review of Consulting costs for the Water Trail mapping guide shows we owe Paschek Associates an additional \$1800.00. This was still very reasonable as John Buerkle agreed to a significant discount as he is very interested in our project. Peggy Pings of the National Park Service sent an email with suggested dates for a Kayak Paddle on each of the mapped routes on the water trail.
DISCUSSION	Dr. Vincent Troia suggested that we coordinate a River Sweep of our own among the ORTC partner communities similar to ORSANCO's. Schedule for next spring. Target areas would be Coraopolis to Ohioville and up the Beaver River. Linda Tice stated they collected three tri-axle dump trailers of refuse just in the Lock 57/Ohioville area last clean-up.
DISCUSSION	A booth was suggested for Cranberry Community Days. Melinda McKee stated it would give us some exposure since they do not know about us in the Cranberry area. Since most people from that area use the Butler Freeport Trails surely they would be interested in the ORTC project as well. The booth fee is \$118.00. Since Cranberry Community Days are only a few weeks away, it was decided we should plan to be there for the 2014 Community Days and send out an notification early in 2014.
DISCUSSION	It was decided that we should schedule the ORTC Open House at CCBC annually as it went well this year.

DISCUSSION	The PA Specialty Plate program will be tied to the ORTC Membership drive. Dr. Vincent Troia showed everyone a sample of the license plate with the ORTC logo. We must submit to PennDOT with a 300 minimum plate order. The PennDOT fee would be \$20.00 per plate and would be included with the ORTC membership. PennDOT charged a \$350 set-up fee.
DISCUSSION	The Steeler Ticket Raffle is underway and Bill Weber has selected the Cincinnati Bengals game for the raffle. Dr. Vincent Troia will talk to Mario Leone about getting them printed. We did not sell all the tickets during the 2012 raffle but we still made a \$3540.00 profit. It was decided that tickets should reflect that unsold tickets remain the property of the ORTC. The Game is scheduled for December 15, 2013.
DISCUSSION	The ORTC Gear and Beer Fall Music Festival is scheduled for Sunday, September 8, 2013. Board Members must be there at 7:00 AM near the foot bridge for registration. All were advised to review the schedule. The W PA Wheelman will sponsor the 50 mile bicycle ride. Raymond Tabay thought Izzo's Monogramming may be agreeable to throwing in a bag if they printed the shirts. It was decided that the shirts should be navy blue again and everyone liked the logo. Snitgers Bicycles will do a short road ride and are mapping a route. Trips maps and route will be coordinated by Marlin Erin. Keystone Sojourns set up at the lake last year and that did not work. They will supply us with a rock wall from 12 to 4. They will also bring boats for the lake and set up a booth for their merchandise. Dr. Troia offered a bronze sponsorship and in return, they will give us the rock wall for \$100.00. All Beer tasting participants must show ID we cannot serve anyone without ID. No one under 21 years of age permitted in the Lodge. Miles of Smiles will coordinate the 5-K again this year. The new registration forms should have all information we need for Miles of Smiles on them. Donna Campbell will coordinate with them so that all the race numbers are done ahead of time. Duane McKee is working on Satellite TV for the Steeler Game during the Festival. Bill Sweterlisch said he had someone checking on the legality and he will be happy to have someone come and set it up. Dr. Troia wants to improve the sound quality of the bands this year, researching concert quality music since we are calling it a Music Festival. The solution would be to hire a sound person but the going rate for this is \$1,000.00 to \$2,000.00. Bill Weber has a client with a good band from Monaca that is willing to coordinate the sound. They will be the premier act and two of his people will handle the sound for a fee of \$760.00. Circle of One is the name of the band. Glass Beer Tasting glasses are permitted in the lodge. We were given brochures with wine and beer plexi-glass glasses samples shown. Rich D'Achilles / Zenan can get us 1000 6 oz. glasses for 1020.00 with Festival Logo. Anyone over 21 who paid \$30/35 will have a glass and they are the only ones allowed to drink. If there are any left we can sell them at other events such as open house, golf outings, etc. Beer tasters will also get T-Shirts. There is a link on the ORTC website that will take you to the Fall fest website. Dr. Troia has been contacting Small craft breweries but has not been getting a good response from them. We also have the donated Anchor Hocking Beer Mugs which Moderne Glass will screen for us for \$136.00 for 240 mugs. We can have the same logo put on them and sell them at the Fall fest. To Date we do not have any vendors except for Keystone Sojourns and China Express. Ambridge Italian Villa is interested as well as few others. We will waive the \$100.00 vendor fee for anyone bringing \$100.00 of product. Product cannot be sold at the event.
DISCUSSION	The Great Ohio Lake to River Greenway is being extended from the Lisbon Trail to Glasgow, PA. The Three Rivers Heritage Trail is connecting Pittsburgh's Southside to Coraopolis.
DISCUSSION	John Szatkiewicz and Linda Tice stated that they are seeing a significant increase in traffic along the old section of Lincoln Highway where they live due to the Lincoln Highway Days. Justin Battalini is taking care of submitting the information for a Historic marker but has not completed this to date. Dr. Troia asked if there were any History teachers at CCBC that would be interested in helping with the historic marker application; Paul Rogers will check.

DISCUSSION	The ORTC project adds an economic value to our region. Trail Town Program has a statistical data report showing what the GAP trail does for their region. The group reviewed some of the benefits of the GAP trail project.
DISCUSSION	Next meeting scheduled for July 23 rd Tuesday 3:00 pm
DISCUSSION	Meeting adjourned at 4:50 pm.